

HANDHELD FIELDMAN FOR PEST SURVEILLANCE

A device that picks up rich and insightful data from agriculture fields, which can be used by the agricultural departments to issue timely advisory to farmers on pest control



Fieldman device developed by Infronics Systems for pest surveillance

■ VANDANA SHARMA

In India over 10,000 species of pests destroy food which could feed 135 million people. The current annual loss due to insects, pests and diseases in the agricultural sector is estimated at Rs 150 billion as there are no standard protocols for control of pests, diseases and weeds in the country. In such a scenario, solutions like Fieldman can surely help find a way forward.

Developed by Infronics Systems in association with the Food & Agriculture Organisation (FAO) and Ministry

of Agriculture, government of India, Fieldman is an ePest surveillance system. "It offers a uniform and standardised process for pest surveillance and data collection from the agricultural fields to monitor and ascertain the health of the crop, and issue timely advisory to farmers," reveals M. Chandrashekar, CEO, Infronics Systems.

Technologies that power Fieldman

"Extensive efforts went into conceiving, designing and developing the Fieldman surveillance system. The system is an amalgam of embedded and communication technologies on a single platform. It is designed to operate in extreme external environmental conditions and has been extensively tested (drop tests on concrete and under rain) and certified," affirms Chandrashekar. There are plug-in sensors for automatic collection of data such as temperature and humidity. The GPS module enables collection of geo-referenced data and the GPRS/GSM module ensures connectivity through the telecom network. The data collected from the fields can be uploaded to a central location for analysis by experts. It is equipped with a rechargeable battery pack to ensure a full day's field operation.

The ePest surveillance system also includes an extensive suite of software applications—both on the Fieldman handheld system and back-end server—to offer uniform surveillance protocol for field data collection about pests. Experts can analyse the collected data and advisories can be

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